MIL-P-38136A(USAF)
27 June 1969
Superseding
MIL-P-38136 (USAF)
2 May 1963

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PITOT-STATIC TUBE, COMPENSATED TRU-62/A

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for an aerodynamically compensated pitot-static tube, designated TRU-62/A.

* 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of
MIL-F-5509	Fittings, Flared Tube, Fluid Connection
MIL-S-7742	Screw Threads, Standard, Optimum Selected Series: General Specification for

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-100	Engineering Drawing Practices
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property
MIL-STD-143	Specifications and Standards, Order of Precedence for the Selection of
MIL-STD-794	Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging and Packing of
MIL-STD-810	Environmental Test Methods
MIL-STD-831	Test Reports, Preparation of
MIL-STD-1247	Identification of Pipe, Hose, and Tube Lines for Aircraft, Missile, and Space Systems
MS33586	Metals, Definition of Dissimilar
MS33656	Fitting End, Standard Dimensions for Flared Tube Connection and Gasket Seal

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Air Force-Navy Aeronautical

AN786 Coupling, Airspeed Tube Union (Brazing)

(Copies of documents required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Qualification. The pitot-static tubes furnished under this specification shall be products which are qualified for listing on the applicable Qualified Products List at the time set for opening of bids (see 4.4 and 6.3).

3.2 Selection of specifications and standards. Specifications and standards for necessary commodities and services not specified herein shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-143.

3.3 Materials. Materials that are not specifically designated shall be of the best commercial quality, of the lightest practicable weight, and suitable for the purpose intended.

3.3.1 Fungus-proof materials. Materials that are nutrients for fungi shall not be used where it is practicable to avoid them. Where used and not hermetically sealed, they shall be treated with a fungicidal agent acceptable to the procuring activity. However, if used in a hermetically sealed inclosure, fungicidal treatment will not be necessary.

3.3.2 Nonmagnetic materials. Nonmagnetic materials shall be used for all parts of the tube, except where magnetic materials are essential.

3.3.3 Nonferrous materials. Nonferrous materials shall be used in all parts of the tube, except where ferrous materials are essential.

3.3.4 Metals. Metals shall be of the corrosion-resistant type or suitably treated to resist corrosion due to fuels, salt spray, or atmospheric conditions likely to be met in storage or normal service.

3.3.4.1 Dissimilar metals. Unless suitably protected against electrolytic corrosion, dissimilar metals shall not be used in intimate contact with each other. Dissimilar metals are defined in MS33586.

3.4 Design and construction

3.4.1 Design. The design of the tube shall conform to figure 1 and shall be such that the tube will sense total and static pressures within the accuracies specified

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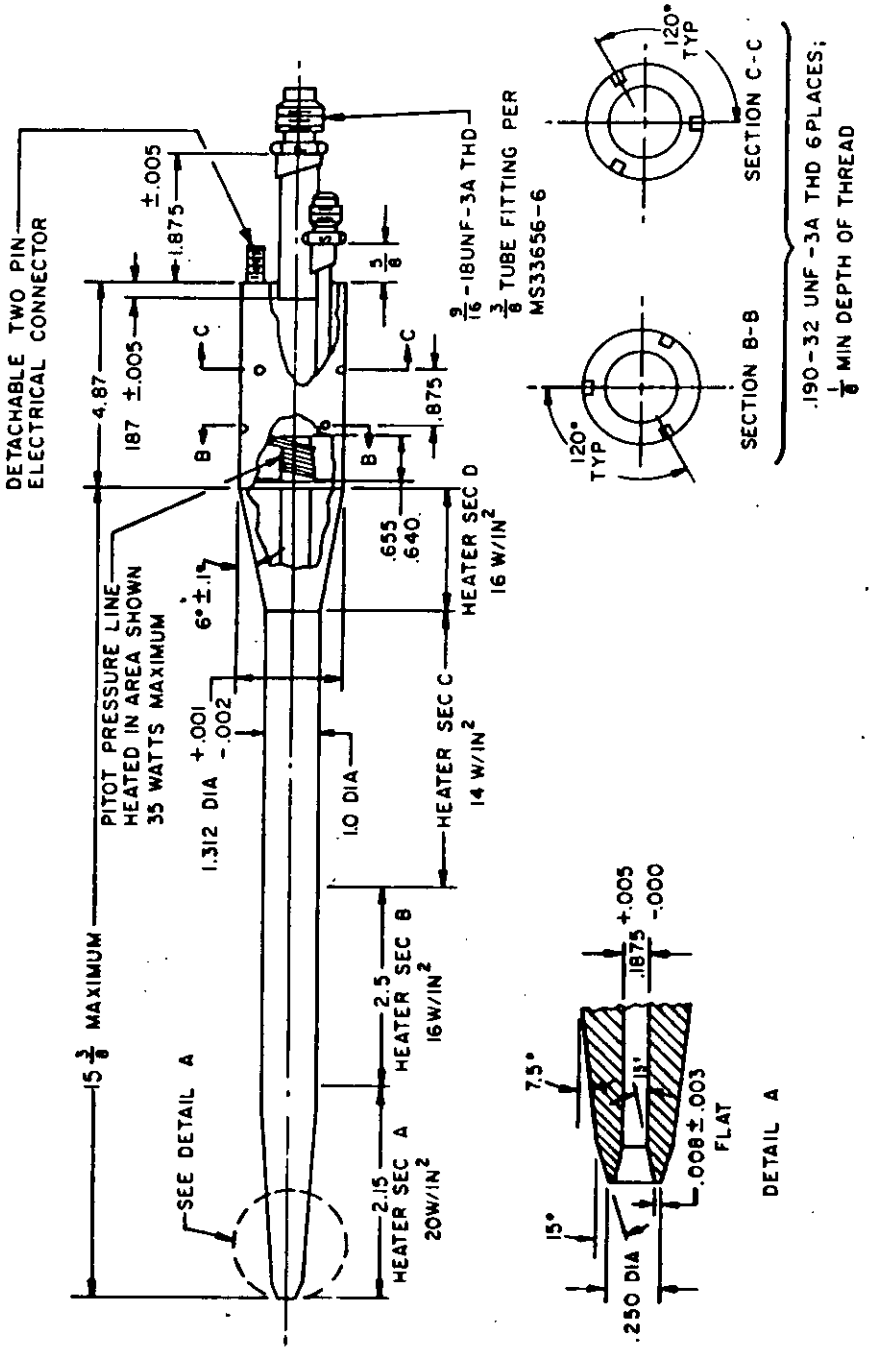


FIGURE 1. Pitot Static Tube

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herein. Aerodynamic compensation shall be achieved by providing an appropriate contour on the nose or shall be such that the accuracies required herein will be achieved over the specified speed range without the use of a mach switch.

3.4.1.1 The contractor shall obtain from the airframe manufacturer the static pressure position error in the region where the tube will be installed on the aircraft. The contractor shall investigate the effects of angle of attack and sideslip on the sensed pressures at this location. Based upon these considerations, a suitable compensating contour and such location of static parts as to meet the performance requirements specified herein shall be determined.

3.4.2 Construction. The tube shall be so constructed as to withstand the strains, jars, vibrations, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, installation, and service.

* 3.5 Performance. The tube shall be capable of meeting the requirements specified herein under the following conditions:

a. Insulation - Voltage potential of 500V rms

b. Vibration - Vibrations for 3 hours, including resonant and cycling conditions in each of the horizontal and vertical axes

c. Heater operation - Operation at rated voltage for a period of 10 hours

d. Static and total pressure error - Wind velocities at mach numbers ranging from 0.2 to 2.5 and angles of attack ranging from -4° to +25°

e. Salt fog - Exposure to salt sea atmosphere for a period of 48 hours

f. High temperature exposure - Exposure to 540°C for a period of 48 hours

g. Low temperature exposure and power consumption - Exposure to -65°C for 48 hours without damage; after 24 hours at this temperature, the tube shall withstand an initial power surge not exceeding 1,700w

h. Humidity - Relative humidity up to 95 percent

i. Rated voltage - Operation from 28V at 400 Hz.

3.5.1 Pressure leakage. The tube shall withstand a pressure of 80 inches Hg for a period of 1 minute.

* 3.5.2 Power consumption. At the end of a 5-minute operating period at rated voltage and still-air conditions, the electrical power consumption shall be 275 watts.

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3.5.3 Deicing and anti-icing. With the tube positioned at 0° and 25° angles of attack, it shall remove and completely clear accumulated ice when subjected to windtunnel speeds of 400 ±25 knots at an altitude between sea level and 10,000 feet, temperature of -35° ±5°C, and with a liquid water content of 1.75 ±0.25 gram per cubic meter.

* 3.5.4 Reliability. The tube shall have a minimum acceptable mean-time-between-failures (MTBF) of 1,000 hours demonstrated to a 90 percent confidence level.

* 3.6 Part numbering of interchangeable parts. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. The item identification and part number requirements of MIL-STD-100 shall govern the manufacturer's part numbers and changes thereto.

3.7 Electrical circuit. The electrical circuit of the tube shall be of the 2-wire type.

3.8 Electrical connector. The electrical connector shall conform to figure 2 and shall be located as shown on figure 3.

3.9 Heater. Power distribution through the heater during the deicing operation shall conform to the minimum wattage densities shown on figure 1. The total overload wattage at any time shall not exceed 1,700w. Heater elements shall be placed as near as practicable to the heater surfaces. The heater shall be regulated automatically in such a manner that the power dissipated through the heater will be an inverse function of the heater element temperature. In still air at ambient temperatures between 20° and 30°C, the heater output shall not exceed 275 $^{+10}_{-25}$ w after 5 minutes of heater operation.

3.9.1 Heat distortion. There shall be no permanent distortion of the tube body as a result of extended heater operation.

3.10 Pressure lines. The forward total pressure line which extends aft to the total pressure chamber shall consist of 5/16-inch outside diameter tubing having a wall thickness of 0.022 inch. The rear total pressure line extending from the total pressure chamber aft to the pneumatic connector shall consist of 3/8-inch outside diameter tubing having a wall thickness of 0.022 inch. The line fitting shall conform to MIL-F-5509 and AN786. The static pressure line shall consist of 5/16-inch outside diameter tubing having a wall thickness of 0.022 inch. The static pressure line fitting shall conform to MIL-F-5509 and figure 4.

3.11 Total pressure chamber. A total pressure chamber shall be provided in the mounting-sleeve section of the tube. The chamber shall be a minimum of 4.25 inches in length and shall have a minimum volume of 3 cubic inches. The two sections of the pitot pressure line shall terminate in the total pressure chamber as shown on figure 1.

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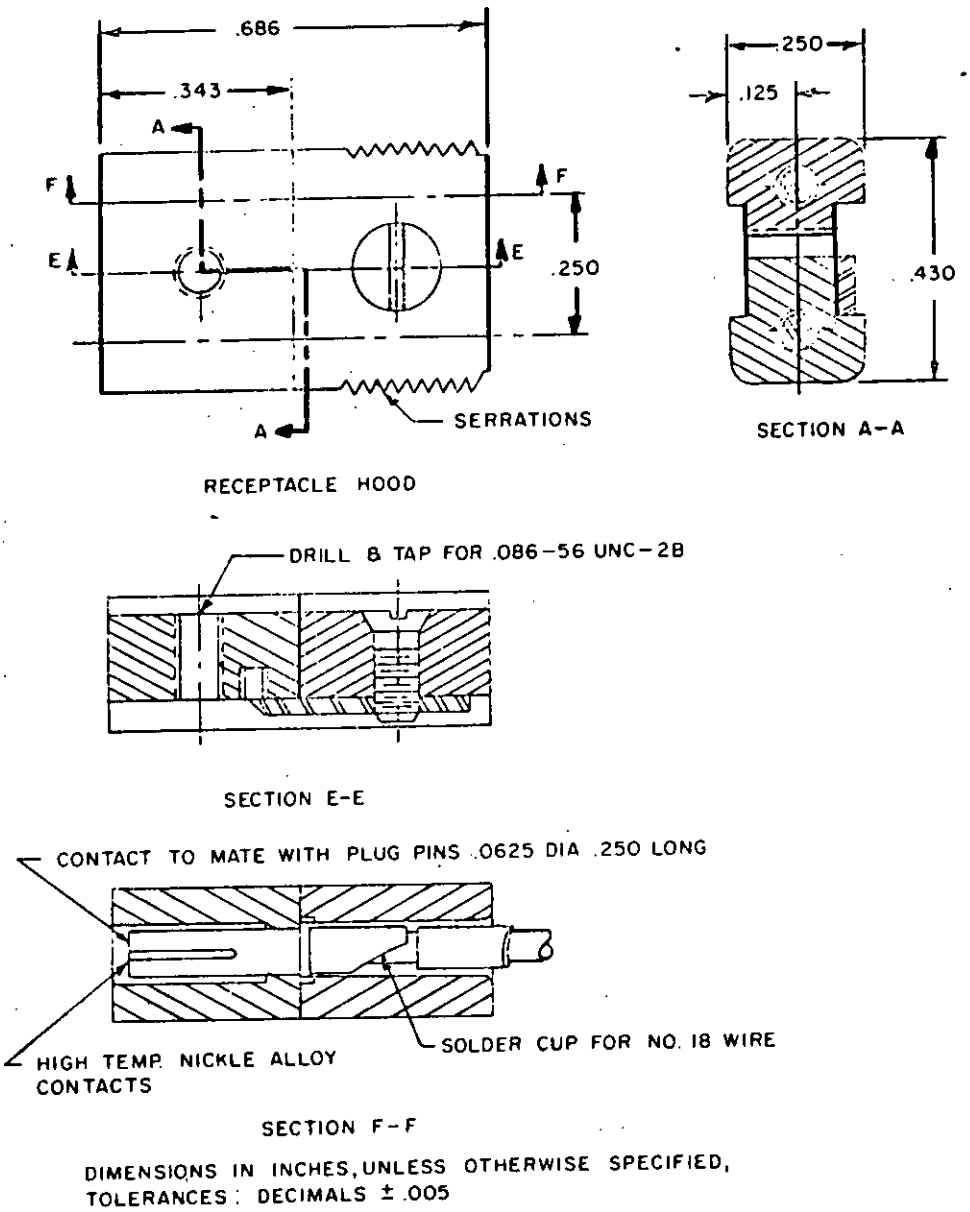
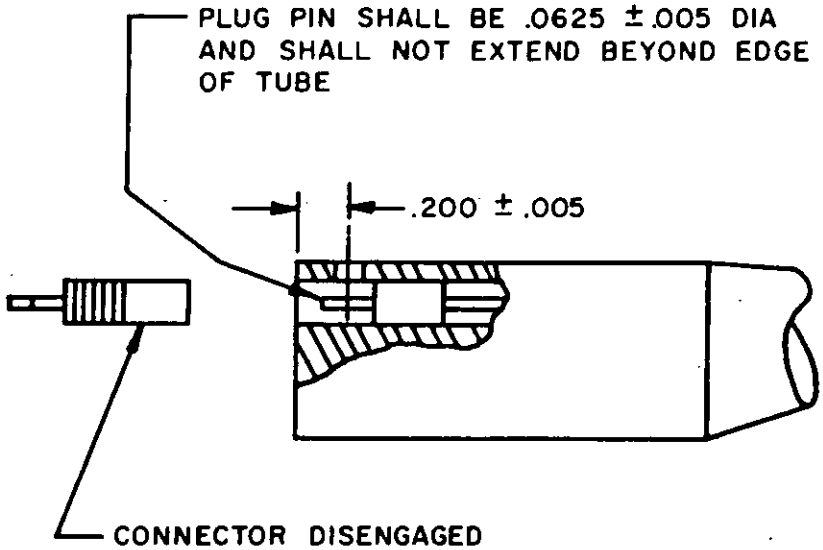
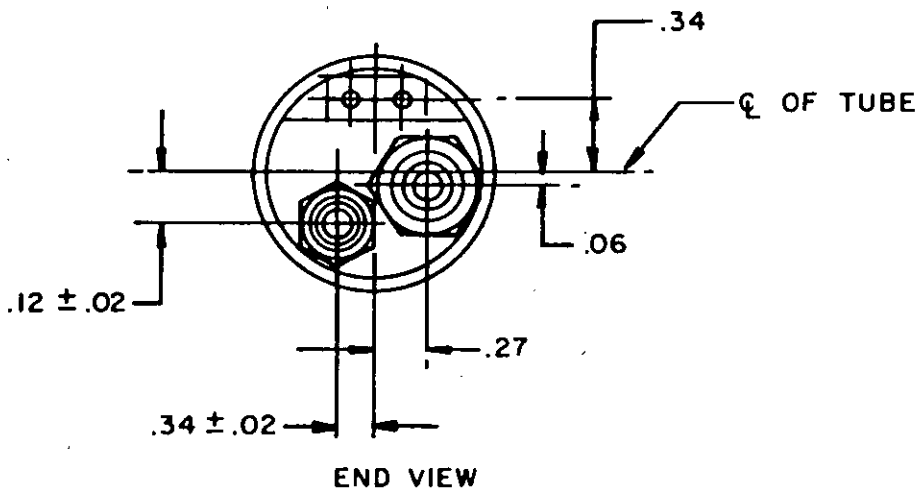


FIGURE 2. Electrical Connector Detail

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DIMENSIONS IN INCHES.
UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED
TOLERANCES: DECIMALS ±.005

FIGURE 3. Electrical Connector Location

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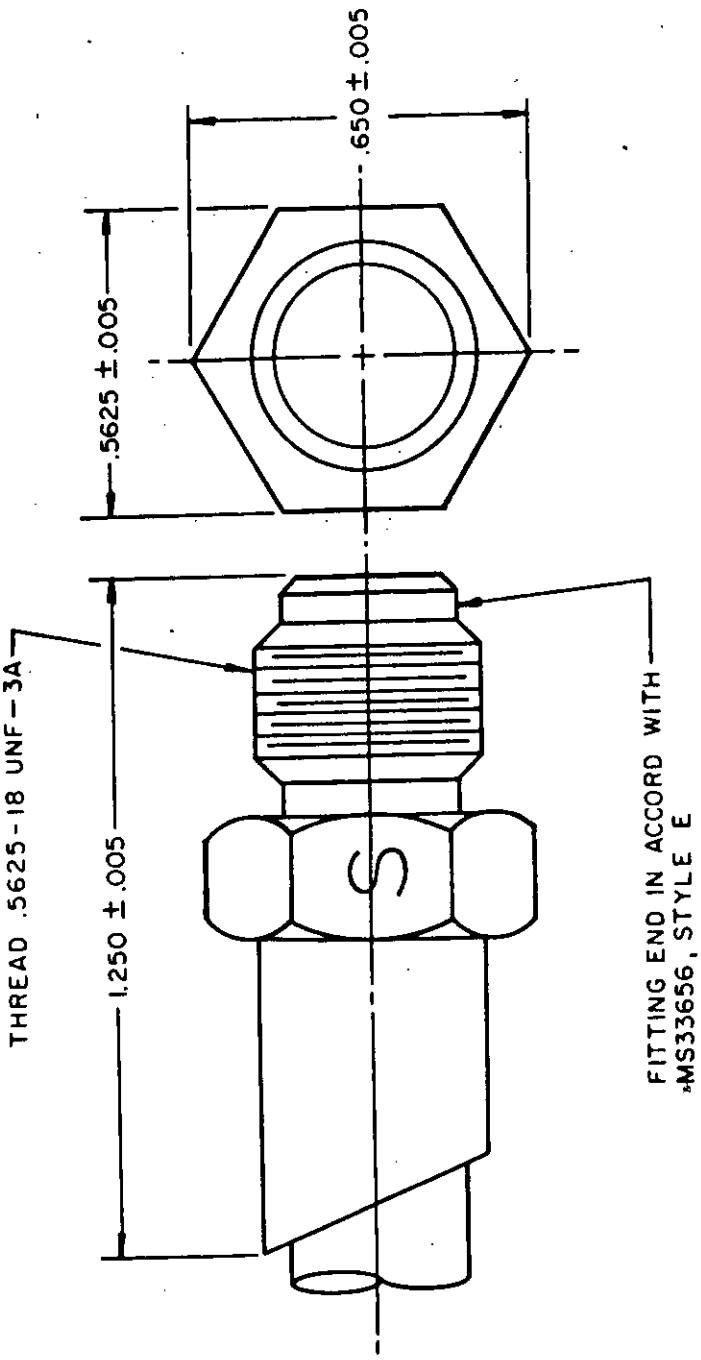


FIGURE 4. Static Pressure Line Fitting

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3.12 Static pressure chamber. The internal volume of the static pressure chamber shall be not less than the internal volume of 3/8-inch outer diameter tubing (0.035 inch wall thickness) having the same length as the static pressure chamber.

3.13 Concentricity. The cylindrical portion of the tube body shall be concentric within ±0.001 inch. There shall be no surface irregularities in the vicinity of the static pressure orifices.

3.14 Drainage. The tube shall be so designed that water can not enter the pressure line under any service condition. A drain hole 0.035 ±0.003 inch in diameter shall be provided in the total pressure chamber to clear any moisture that may collect. A drain hole 0.040 ±0.003 inch in diameter shall be located within 4 inches of the tube tip to minimize the passage of moisture to the total pressure line.

* 3.15 Screw threads. The threads of all machine screws shall conform to MIL-S-7742.

3.16 Weight. The weight of the tube, including the electrical connector and mounting screws, shall not exceed 1.75 pounds.

3.17 Finishes. Finishes and protective coatings that will crack, chip, or scale during normal service life or due to extremes of atmospheric conditions shall not be used. The outside of the tube shall have a durable dull finish acceptable to the procuring activity.

3.18 Protective caps. The total pressure opening and pressure line coupling threads shall be protected by slip-on caps of nonstrategic material. The design of all protective devices shall be subject to the approval of the procuring activity.

3.19 Identification of product. Equipment, assemblies, and parts shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130. Identifying information shall be etched, engraved, or stamped on each tube in a location that will not interfere with airflow over the tube or its operation.

* 3.19.1 The total pressure and static lines shall be identified by the letters P and S, respectively, and shall be stamped, etched, or engraved on the coupling. The pressure line shall be color-marked in accordance with MIL-STD-1247. The top of the tube mounting shoulder shall be stamped, etched, or engraved with the word TOP in letters 1/8 inch high, marked in the space between the aft end of the rear tapered shoulder and the forward row of mounting holes.

3.20 Workmanship. The tube shall be constructed and finished in a thoroughly workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to neatness and thoroughness of soldering, wiring, marking of parts and assemblies, welding and brazing, painting, riveting, machine-screw assemblies, and freedom of parts from burrs and sharp edges.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 Classification of tests. The inspection and testing of tubes shall be classified as follows:

a. Preproduction tests

b. Quality conformance tests.

4.3 Test conditions

4.3.1 Standard atmospheric conditions. Whenever the pressure and temperature existing at the time of the test are not specified, the test shall be made at atmospheric pressure (approximately 29.92 inches Hg) and at room temperature (approximately +25°C). When tests are made with atmospheric pressure or room temperature differing materially from the above values, proper allowance shall be made for the difference from the specified condition.

* 4.3.2 Rated voltage. The pitot-static tube shall be operated on a rated voltage of 115V 400 Hz. Normal voltage fluctuation shall have no effect on the unit.

4.3.3 All tests shall be conducted with the mating electrical connector installed.

* 4.4 Preproduction testing

* 4.4.1 Test samples. The test samples shall consist of six tubes representative of the production equipment. Three tubes shall be subjected to all the tests except reliability and three shall be subjected to the reliability test only. The samples shall be identified with the manufacturer's part number and such other information as required by the procuring activity.

* 4.4.2 Test report. The contractor shall prepare a test report in accordance with MIL-STD-831 (see 6.3).

* 4.4.3 Preproduction tests. The preproduction tests shall consist of all the tests specified under 4.6.

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4.5 Quality conformance tests. Quality conformance tests shall consist of:

a. Individual tests

b. Sampling tests

4.5.1 Individual tests. Each tube shall be subjected to the following tests as described under 4.6:

a. Examination of product

b. Insulation

c. Pressure leakage

d. Power consumption

4.5.2 Sampling tests

* 4.5.2.1 Sampling plan A. One tube selected at random from each 40 or less produced on the contract or order shall be subjected to the following tests described under 4.6:

a. Individual tests

b. Vibration

c. Heater operation.

4.5.2.2 Sampling plan B. Unless otherwise specified, 3 tubes shall be selected at random from the first 15 produced on the contract or order and subjected to the following tests as described under 4.6:

a. Sampling plan A tests

b. Deicing and anti-icing

c. Static and total pressure errors

d. Salt fog

e. High-temperature resistance

f. Low-temperature resistance and power consumption

g. Humidity.

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4.5.2.3 Rejection and retest. When one item selected from a production run fails to meet the specification, no items still on hand or later produced will be accepted until the extent and cause of failure are determined. After corrections have been made, all necessary tests shall be repeated.

4.5.2.3.1 Individual tests may continue. For operational and production reasons, individual tests may be continued pending the investigation of a sampling test failure. But final acceptance of items on hand or later produced shall not be made until it is determined that items meet all the requirements of this specification.

4.5.3 Defects in items already accepted. The investigation of a test failure could indicate that defects may exist in items already accepted. If so, the contractor shall advise the procuring activity of all defects likely to be found and methods of correcting them.

4.6 Test methods

4.6.1 Examination of product. The tube shall be carefully examined to determine compliance with the requirements specified herein with respect to materials, finish, weight, markings, and workmanship.

4.6.2 Insulation. The tube shall be subjected to a high-potential test with 550V rms of commercial frequency applied between each terminal and the case for a period of 1 minute. Upon completion of testing, there shall be no damage to the wiring or insulation. In the event a hermetically sealed heater is utilized, the tube shall be placed in a chamber and evacuated to a pressure equal to an altitude of 80,000 feet for a period of 4 hours. At the end of this period, 150V ac shall be applied between each terminal and the case for 60 seconds. No damage to the wiring or insulation shall result.

4.6.3 Pressure leakage. A pressure of 80 inches Hg shall be applied to each of the pressure lines. With the total and static pressure orifices and drain holes sealed, the applied pressure after 1 minute shall not be below 79.97 inches Hg.

* 4.6.4 Power consumption. At an ambient temperature between 20° and 30°C, rated voltage shall be applied through a 15-amp fuse to the terminals of the tube for a period of 5 minutes. After this 5-minute period, the power shall be measured and shall be 275 watts.

4.6.5 Vibration. The tube shall be mounted in a sleeve at the aft end and subjected to vertical and horizontal vibrations perpendicular to the tube centerline in such a manner that a point on the top will oscillate through an amplitude of 1/4 inch. The test shall consist of three 1-hour periods at 1,000, 2,000, and 3,000 cpm during which the tube shall be operated continuously at rated voltage and an ambient temperature between 20° and 30°C. The tube shall then meet the test specified in 4.6.3. No damage to the tube shall result from this test.

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4.6.6 Heater operation. At an ambient temperature of between 20° and 30°C, rated voltage shall be applied for an uninterrupted period of 10 minutes. Corrosion resistance and proper operation of the tube shall not be affected. The tube body shall be checked dimensionally to determine that no permanent distortion or warpage has resulted due to heater operation. The pressure leakage and insulation tests shall then be repeated after which the tube body shall again be checked dimensionally to determine that no permanent distortion or warpage has resulted.

4.6.7 Deicing and anti-icing. The tube shall be tested in an ice tunnel at a tunnel indicated airspeed of 400 ±25 knots and an ambient temperature of -35° ±5°C. The water droplet size shall be regulated to provide a liquid water content of 1.75 ±0.25 gram per cubic meter. During this test, the connecting pressure lines and the tube shall be unheated. The connecting static and total pressure lines shall have maximum internal diameters of 0.305 and 0.180 inch, respectively. Under these conditions, the tube shall be tested as follows:

4.6.7.1 The tube shall be mounted in the icing wind tunnel at a 0° angle of attack. Ice shall be allowed to form on the tube until either (a) the total pressure opening has been sealed or (b) the icecap has extended 1/2 inch in front of the tube tip. Power shall then be applied at rated voltage. The total time required to achieve correct pressure readings shall not exceed 1 minute, and to remove all accumulated ice shall not exceed 1 minute and 30 seconds. The tube shall continue to operate for 3 hours at rated voltage, after which the angle of attack shall be increased to 4°. The icing environment shall not be interrupted when this change is made. The tube shall continue to operate for an additional 1 hour at rated voltage and at the 4° angle of attack. During this entire test period, no ice shall form on the tube or within the tube or attached pressure lines that will affect the pitot and static pressure measurements.

4.6.7.2 The tube shall be mounted in the icing wind tunnel at a 25° angle of attack. Ice shall be allowed to form on the tube until either (a) the total pressure opening has been sealed or (b) the icecap has extended 1/2 inch in front of the tube tip. Power shall then be applied at rated voltage. The total time required to achieve correct pressure readings shall not exceed 1 minute, and to remove all accumulated ice shall not exceed 1 minute and 30 seconds. The tube shall continue to operate for an additional 15 minutes at rated voltage without ice forming on the tube to such extent as to affect the pitot and static pressure measurements.

* 4.6.8 Static and total pressure error. The tube shall be mounted in a wind tunnel and tested to determine static and total pressure errors. The tube errors shall be determined by comparing the pressures sensed by the tube with actual tunnel pressures. The tube shall be tested at speeds from mach 0.2 to mach 1.1 in increments of 0.1 mach, and at mach 1.5, 2.0, and 2.5. In addition, the tube shall be tested for angle of attack effect at the test points specified in table I.

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TABLE I. Angle of Attack Effect

Mach No.	Test at -4° angle of attack, 0° to 16° in 2° increments, 20° and 25° angle of attack	Test at -4° angle of attack and 0° to 14° angle of attack in 2° increments	Test from 0° to 10° angle of attack in 2° increments
0.2	X		
0.3	X		
0.4	X		
0.5	X		
0.6		X	
0.8		X	
1.0		X	
1.1		X	
1.5			X
2.0			X
2.5			X

The static pressure sensed by the tube shall be such that when the tube is installed on the aircraft at the location specified (see 3.4.1.1), the residual static pressure errors shall not exceed ±0.02 $\Delta P/qc$ up to mach 1.1 and shall not exceed ±0.01 $\Delta P/qc$ above mach 1.1. At angles of attack other than 0°, the accuracies shall be as shown on figure 5. The total pressure measured by the tube shall not differ by more than 1/2 percent from the actual total pressure in the tunnel at 0° angle of attack. At other angles of attack, the total pressure sensed by the tube shall not differ by more than 1 percent from the actual total pressure in the tunnel. The vendor shall substantiate a reproducibility of ±0.002 Q_c by aerodynamic testing of each production pitot-static tube.

4.6.9 Salt fog. The tube shall be subjected to a salt fog test in accordance with method 509 of MIL-STD-810.

4.6.10 High-temperature resistance. The tube shall be subjected to a temperature of 540°C for a period of 48 hours. At the end of this time, there shall be no evidence of damage. At the option of the procuring activity, any or all tests may be conducted after this test.

4.6.11 Low-temperature resistance and power consumption. The tube shall be subjected to a temperature of -65°C for a period of 48 hours. After 24 hours at low temperature, rated voltage shall be applied to the tube through a 25-amp circuit breaker. The initial power surge shall not exceed 1,700w and shall not be of such a duration as to render the circuit breaker inoperative. After 5 seconds, the power

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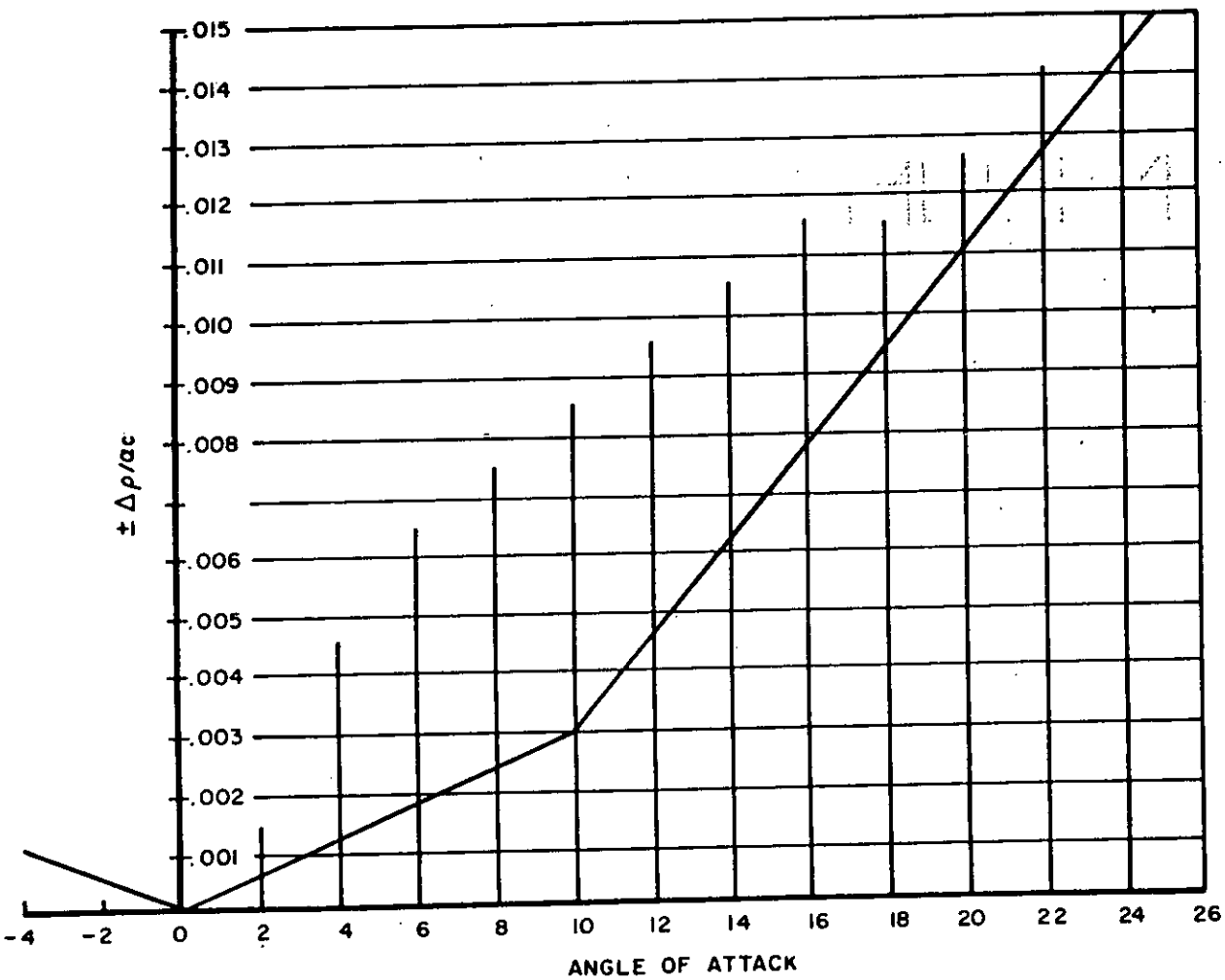


FIGURE 5. Additional Tolerances for Static Pressure Sensing at Angle of Attack

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consumption shall not exceed 850w and after 20 seconds shall not exceed 675w. Power shall then be removed. At the end of the 48-hour period, there shall be no damage to the tube. At the option of the procuring activity, any or all of the tests may be conducted after this test.

4.6.12 Humidity. The tube shall be subjected to a humidity test in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 507, procedure I. There shall be no detrimental effect on heater operation or deterioration of the tube body. At the completion of this test, the tube shall meet the test specified in 4.6.2.

* 4.6.13 Reliability. A reliability test shall be conducted to demonstrate a minimum acceptable MTBF of 1,000 hours to a 90 percent confidence level. The combined test time of the three indicators shall total 1,000 x T hours with not more than the corresponding M number of failures as defined in table II. During this test, the tubes shall be subjected to the environmental conditions specified in table III.

TABLE II. Reliability

M (number of failures)	T (X 1,000 to establish total combined test time)
0	4.4
1	5.2
2	6
3	6.8
4	7.6
5	8.5

TABLE III. Reliability Test Conditions

Percent of Test Time	Environmental Condition
30	Simulated airflow of 200 - 400 knots at 0° ±5°C
35	Simulated airflow of 200 - 400 knots at 0° ±5°C while subjected to vibration in accordance with MIL-STD-810, figure 514-1, curve B
35	Room temperature (power applied for 10 hours and removed for 1 hour)

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* 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging

5.1.1 Level A. Each pitot-static tube shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1A8, and individually packaged in accordance with MIL-STD-794.

5.1.2 Level C. Each pitot-static tube shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level C of MIL-STD-794.

5.2 Packing

5.2.1 Levels A and B. Pitot-static tubes preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-794.

5.2.2 Level C. Packages that require overpacking for acceptance by the carrier shall be packed in exterior-type shipping containers in a manner that will insure safe transportation at the lowest rate to the point of delivery. Containers shall meet the consolidated freight classification rules or regulations of other common carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking for shipment. Interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked for shipment in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The TRU-62/A pitot-static tube covered by this specification is intended for use on aircraft to supply total and static pressures for flight instruments and control equipment.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification

b. When sampling plan B tests will not be conducted

c. Levels of packaging and packing required.

6.3 Test report. The contractor will submit three copies of the test report specified in 4.4.2 to the procuring activity for approval.

6.4 Marginal indicia. The outside margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions)

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from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in those notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Review activity:
Air Force - 71

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

Project No. 6610-F099

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

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